14.11 Heat Stroke*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Collapsed while working outdoors in summer **Objective** • Core temperature 41 °C • Hot, dry skin • Confused	**ACTUAL** Hyperthermia related to exposure to high environmental temperature as evidenced by core temperature 41 °C, hot skin and confusion.	• Core temperature below 39 °C within 30 minutes.	• Move him somewhere cool and remove his clothing. • Cool fast: cold-water immersion, or evaporative cooling with ice packs at the neck, armpits and groin. • Monitor core temperature continuously; stop active cooling at about 39 °C per protocol. • Watch for seizures.	• Achieved when temperature is on target.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • HR 130/min • BP 90/60 mmHg • Small amounts of dark urine	**ACTUAL** Inadequate fluid volume related to excessive sweating and heat exposure as evidenced by tachycardia, hypotension and low urine output.	• Adequate urine output with stable vital signs.	• Give IV fluids as prescribed. • Measure urine hourly; dark urine may mean rhabdomyolysis. • Follow electrolytes, creatinine and CK.	• Outcome reached when he is stable.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Heat-related encephalopathy • Confused	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: seizures and confusion associated with heat stroke.	• No injury.	• Put seizure precautions in place. • Give anticonvulsants as prescribed if seizures occur. • Observe him closely.	• Considered met if no injury occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [18], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.